

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
WASHINGTON

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY

31 MAR 1958

MEMORANDUM FOR DIRECTOR OF INFORMATION SERVICES

SUBJECT: McClellan Subcommittee Statement Concerning Force
Handling of UFO Reports

1. Reference is made to your memorandum of 28 January 1958,
subject as above.

2. The reason for the delay in my reply is that considerable ex-
ploratory work has been done with the Committee and the staff relative
to your suggestion. However, the general attitude of the Committee is
that while they feel that it is not worthwhile to invest further time
and money in this area, plus the fact that the Air Force is conducting
its own investigation, they will not make a release to this effect at
this time.

3. In cases of this type, we have found that Congressional Com-
mittees are not prone to commit themselves in the way you suggest.
Therefore, while the Committee's attitude now is that they are not go-
ing to pursue this matter further, they have indicated that they would
not so commit themselves publicly for if the situation should change at
a later date they would not want to be shackled by a press release in-
dicating that they had no further interest in the matter.

Joe W. Kelly
JOE W. KELLY
Major General, USAF
Director, Legislative Liaison

Director
Aerospace Studies Inst
ATTN: Archives Branch
Maxwell AFB, Alabama

Force

RETURN TO:

K243.612-15
Feb-Mar 1958

1003839

FEB 28 1958

MEMORANDUM FOR DIRECTOR OF LEGISLATIVE LIAISON

SUBJECT: McClellan Subcommittee Statement Concerning Air Force
Handling of UFO Reports

1. Investigators for the McClellan Subcommittee (the Senate Committee on Investigating Government Operations) recently held informal discussions (31 January 1958) with us concerning the advisability of conducting public hearings on the Air Force's position regarding unidentified flying objects. The thing they were concerned with most was the charge that the Air Force was withholding information on this subject. I am sure we convinced them that this was not the case, as they have since indicated there is no need for hearings on this subject.
2. In view of these findings, based upon their preliminary informal investigation, this office would like to see the McClellan Subcommittee issue a statement certifying that a preliminary investigation by the Committee proved that the Air Force is properly conducting its investigation of unidentified flying objects and is not withholding information on this subject from the public. If possible, the statement should include that the Air Force has a definite public information plan in effect concerning unidentified flying objects.
3. Request SAFLL review the possibility and/or feasibility of obtaining such a statement from the McClellan Subcommittee.


ARNO H. LUEHMAN
Major General, USAF
Director of Information Services

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✓ COMEBACK-SAFIS-3
READER-SAFIS-1
STAYBACK-SAFIS-3

FEB 3 1958

MEMORANDUM FOR DEPUTY DIRECTOR OF INFORMATION SERVICES, SAFS

SUBJECT: Congressional Public Hearings - Unidentified Flying Objects

1. Major Donald Keyhoe of the National Investigation Committee on Aerial Phenomena has been badgering the members of the McClellan Subcommittee, the Senate Committee on Investigating Government Operations, to hold open hearings on the question of the existence of unidentified flying objects.

2. In this regard investigators for the subcommittee contacted SAFLL and a meeting was held on 31 January 1958 at 1000 hours in Mr. Horner's office on the Air Force's position regarding possible hearings. Members of the committee attending this meeting were:

Mr. William Weitzen, Deputy for Research & Development Operations

Lt. Colonel William R. Kelzo, SAFRD

Major Joseph E. Boland, SAFLL

Major James F. Byrne, AFCIN

Major Lawrence J. Tacker, SAFIS

Mr. Donald O'Donnell, FBI (Committee Investigator)

Mr. Jack Healey, FBI (Committee Investigator)

3. The committee's investigators simply asked if the Air Force desired such hearings. Mr. Weitzen stated that he did not see the need for it but would cooperate in every way possible if the committee thought the hearings necessary. Mr. Jack Healey stated they wanted a definite Air Force position. Mr. Weitzen said he would have to wait until Mr. Horner returned but thought Mr. Horner would agree with his statement that we would cooperate in every way. The two investigators were invited to visit ATIC at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base for background information. They said they would do so if hearings developed.

SAFIS-3/Maj Tacker/jmd/74966/3 Feb 58

4. There will be a meeting of this group again this week when Mr. Horner returns and gives his views.

5. Major Tacker pointed out during the discussions that OIS was providing the publicity at the present time on this subject at the request of AFCIN. He stated we would continue to do so and would cooperate in every way with the staff agencies concerned or with the congressional committee if hearings are held.

GLEN W. CLARK
Colonel, USAF
Chief, Public Information Division
Office of Information Services

~~COMEBACK-SAFIS-3~~
~~READER-SAFIS-1~~
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